ORIGINAL EXPERIENCE · UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH

I Want to Tell You How I Got Into Research

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> **Most people do undergraduate research for a portfolio. I did it for a different reason.**

BACKGROUND: A lot of people get into undergraduate research for the sole purpose of building a portfolio. But I saw it from a different perspective.

METHODS: A drop year, and an individual who believed in me quite a lot.

RESULTS: I joined college and forgot all the whys and hows of why I got there.

CONCLUSIONS: These ideas would eventually become the foundation of my interest in research.

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BACKGROUND

A lot of people get into undergraduate research for the sole purpose of building a portfolio so that they can go abroad, write the USMLE exam, or see it as a clearance aspect for their PLAB or AMC exams.

THE DIFFERENCE

But I saw it from a different perspective.

It all started with how I got into MBBS in the first place.

METHODS

I studied at PC Thomas Classes, and just before my drop year, I was influenced by an individual who believed in me quite a lot.

He told me all about whole-food, plant-based diets and veganism. He was a vegan himself.

METHODS

He talked to me about Dr. Michael Greger, Neal Barnard, and the greats who had been working on preventive medicine and the Physicians Committee for Responsible Medicine.

This was even before I had even seen a medical college for the first time.

SKEPTICISM

SKEPTICISM

He showed me Cowspiracy, Seaspiracy and all these movies that showed us what happens when you consume a lot of meat.

I was skeptical about a lot of this, but yet I listened to him because whole-food, plant-based diets did have substance to them. And I kept that close to my heart.

THE CROSSROADS

I was very infuriated and washed away by the amount of time invested into NEET UG preparation. I had enough of it.

After my first attempt, I had enough marks to get into veterinary medicine or BDS, and I had decided that I would take whatever I got.

THE CROSSROADS

> **I told my mom and dad that I wanted to give it another go.**

And that’s how I decided to drop and repeat for an MBBS seat.

RESULTS

When I joined college, I was actually consumed by the need to fit in, to be validated, to be understood, to be loved.

I discussed these ideas with some of them in the initial days, but I was ridiculed for a while. I guess I just pushed them all out.

RESULTS

COVID twice. College dynamics, politics, arts. All of it took up a lot of my attention.

I forgot about that guardian angel who actually took me to medical college. I forgot all the whys and hows of why I got there.

CONCLUSIONS

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But you could say that all these decisions led me to where I am right now.

I didn’t know then that these ideas would eventually become the foundation of my interest in research.

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